FITCHBURG STATE UNIVERSITY

Guy Karlebach <gkarleba@fitchburgstate.edu>

Decision on your submission to Acta Biotheoretica

Guy Karlebach <gkarleba@fitchburgstate.edu> Wed, Nov 4, 2026 at 11:57 AM
To: f.j.a.jacobs@biology.leidenuniv.nl

Dear Dr. Jacobs,

Thank you for your email.

According to the online review system, two reviewers were invited and accepted the task of reviewing the manuscript on October 20 2025 and October 28 2025. One of them simply never sent their review. I have in fact contacted you nine months ago, on Feb 2 2026 regarding this issue, and received the following response:

“I have received one review report for your submitted article. The policy of Acta Biotheoretica is to base decisions on submissions on two external review reports. A second reviewer still has to be found. 17 reviewers so far have been invited, no one accepted the invitation to review. This is no indication of the quality of the paper, review processes these days take much time due to the busy schedules of invited reviewers and the resulting high number of declinations. I shall inform you on the decision of the manuscript as soon as possible. “

My manuscript was submitted on Aug 24 2025, a year and three months ago. During the time that passed since, I’ve reviewed many manuscripts, many of them for Springer Nature and indeed one for your very own journal. In none of these cases the allocated review time was nearly as long, typically 10-14 days. Expected time to accept a review was 24 hours. While I always submitted my reviews on time, in one case due to a system error the editor could not see the review, and sent me a notification 3 days after the deadline stating: “Your review is now **3** days late. As you know, timely reviews are of utmost importance to authors, therefore I would be grateful if you would submit your review as soon as possible.”

On July 13 2026 you sent me a request to revise the manuscript based on one of the reviewers who sent a small number of comments, and for which I sent, two weeks later, a revised manuscript and a detailed point-by-point

response, including experiments that answered all the reviewer's questions. I have never received any reply to my response, or any communication from the journal until your email today.

I would greatly appreciate your comment.

Sincerely,

Guy Karlebach

---------- Forwarded message ---------
From: **Acta Biotheoretica** <preethibala.elayaperumal@springernature.com>
Date: Wed, Nov 4, 2026 at 5:39 AM
Subject: Decision on your submission to Acta Biotheoretica
To: <gkarleba@fitchburgstate.edu>

Ref: Submission ID 267414b2-e772-4634-92b7-81aa804e214b

Dear Dr Karlebach,

Your manuscript "Bayesian Inference of Posterior Error Probabilities for Disease-Mutation Association" has now been assessed. If there are any reviewer comments on your manuscript, you can find them at the end of this email.

Regrettably, your manuscript has been rejected for publication in Acta Biotheoretica.

Thank you for the opportunity to review your work. I'm sorry that we cannot be more positive on this occasion and hope you will not be deterred from submitting future work to Acta Biotheoretica.

Kind regards,

Frans Jacobs
Editor
Acta Biotheoretica

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Dear Dr. Karlebach,

after having invited more than 30 reviewer of which only a single one accepted the invitation to review, I have decided to end the review process. To my regret the one review report available mentions too much issues to allow for a revision.

Frans Jacobs